

a feature that has been present in Linux since the 90s and is coming in Windows 10 as well. For current Windows users there is Dexpot, VirtuaWin, and Desktops 2.0 by Microsoft.

## Gamepad emulator

We're going to look at "gamepad emulators" a little differently here. While there are tools that emulate the presence of a gamepad when there is none, and take input from the mouse and keyboard instead, such tools are usually limited in use to within gaming console emulators. Other gamepad emulators such as the x360ce take non-XBOX360 game controllers and make them appear to the computer as an XBOX360 controller, since many games only support those.

A more interesting use case though is using your gamepad as a mouse and keyboard. By mapping joysticks to mouse movements and button presses to mouse buttons and keyboard keys (or sequences) you can play games that don't support gamepads using one. Alternatively a gamepad — especially a wireless one — can be used as a remote control for your computer, allowing you to pause / play while watching a movie or listening to music.

For this second use case there are a number of applications, free and paid: Xpadder is probably the most popular app for using your gamepad as a mouse and keyboard. However it is not free — anymore. It is only available for Windows.

JoytoKey is a shareware application that has a less friendly UI but gets

the job done. Antimicro is a free and opensource tool that works on Windows and Linux.

QJoyPad hasn't been updated in years, but still works, but only on Linux.

Logitech Profiler is software that comes with a Logitech gamepad and supports binding key and mouse presses to gamepad buttons.



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